

MENGJIAO LI

LL.M. Candidate | European and International Law | Legal Research

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

LL.M. candidate in European and International Law with legal training in China and Germany, and an interdisciplinary background in social work. Research interests include foreign and international social law, European public law, international human rights law, and the legal protection of vulnerable groups. Experienced in comparative legal research, case-file analysis, legal memoranda, and the systematic use of European and international legal sources.

EDUCATION

Saarland University, Europa-Institut — Saarbrücken, Germany

Oct 2025 – Present

LL.M. in European and International Law | Focus: European and International Protection of Human Rights

- Current transcript average: 14.8/20 based on completed and recorded coursework; final grades pending.
- Selected coursework: European Law and European Integration (16/20); Global Protection of Human Rights (15/20); Regional Protection of Human Rights in Europe (14/20); Public International Law; Compliance and Governance.

Yunnan University — Kunming, China

Sep 2021 – Jul 2025

Master of Law | Concentration: Criminal Procedure Law | GPA: 3.58/4.00

- Awarded First-Class Graduate Scholarship twice and recognised as an Outstanding Graduate of Yunnan University.

Saarland University — Saarbrücken, Germany

Oct 2023 – Aug 2024

Exchange Programme | Human Rights Law and European Law

Shangqiu Normal University — Shangqiu, China

Sep 2017 – Jun 2021

Bachelor's Degree in Social Work (degree awarded: Bachelor of Laws) | Final grade: 85.48/100

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Foreign and international social law • European public law • International human rights law • Social rights and welfare governance • Juvenile justice and children's rights • Comparative legal research

SELECTED ACADEMIC WORK

Seminar Paper — Recent Case Law of the Court of Justice of the European Union

2026

- "The Primacy of EU Law and the Limits of Ultra Vires Review: Reflections on Commission v Poland (C-448/23)" — graded 19/20 (excellent).

Master's Thesis — Criminal Procedure Law

2025

- "The Functional Role of Defence Lawyers in Juvenile Criminal Cases," examining procedural safeguards and effective legal representation for children in conflict with the law.

LEGAL AND RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

People’s Procuratorate of Dengfeng, Juvenile Prosecution Department — ChinaOct 2024 – Dec 2024

Legal Intern

- Reviewed more than 50 case files involving juvenile justice, public-interest protection, and the rights of vulnerable persons; identified legally relevant facts, procedural issues, and evidentiary inconsistencies.
- Prepared legal summaries, internal memoranda, and research notes to support prosecutorial decision-making and case strategy.
- Assisted with reports and recommendations on juvenile crime prevention, procedural safeguards, and rights protection.

Dacheng Law Offices — Fuzhou, ChinaMar 2022 – Apr 2022

Legal Intern

- Conducted legal research in civil and family law matters and prepared concise case summaries for supervising lawyers.
- Assisted in drafting legal documents, organising case files, and reviewing procedural materials.
- Observed court proceedings and strengthened practical understanding of legal reasoning, evidence, and civil procedure.

Shangqiu Elderly Care Center — Shangqiu, ChinaMar 2021 – Jun 2021

Social Work Intern

- Supported welfare-related and social-engagement activities for elderly residents, with particular attention to social participation and vulnerability.
- Facilitated communication among residents, family members, and care staff, gaining practical insight into ageing, social support, and access to services.

AWARDS AND QUALIFICATIONS

Chinese Legal Professional Qualification Certificate (Class A)
First-Class Graduate Academic Scholarship, Yunnan University — 2022–2023 and 2024–2025
Outstanding Graduate Award, Yunnan University — 2025

RESEARCH AND TECHNICAL SKILLS

Legal research	Comparative and doctrinal legal research; case-law analysis; legal memoranda; case-file review; academic writing
Legal databases	EUR-Lex, CURIA, HUDOC, Westlaw and institutional legal resources
Software	Microsoft Word (academic document formatting), PowerPoint and Excel

LANGUAGES

Chinese: Native | English: Professional working proficiency | German: A1 (currently learning)

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Current location: Saarbrücken, Germany. Available for flexible part-time research work.